AICTE Approval Requirements Reference (APH 2024-27)

Rule-source sheet for the AICTE Trust Layer checklist and rules engine

0. Read This First

This sheet collects what could be confirmed from AICTE's own documents and notices (EoA letters, the AICTE FAQ, the public notice for 2026-27 and handbook excerpts). **I could not open the full handbook PDF, so this is not a verbatim copy of every clause.** Each row carries a status:

- **Confirmed**: appears in official AICTE material (EoA letters, FAQ, public notice, handbook excerpt).
- **Reported**: from a secondary source (news, college "info to AICTE" pages). Treat as likely, and check.
- **Verify**: expected to exist, but the exact wording, number or clause was not confirmed.

There is no single fixed number of documents. The checklist depends on the application category, on whether the institution is new, existing, or applying for a new programme, and on state-specific papers. College "Info to AICTE" pages show portal checklists with item numbers running past 50 for full land, building and affidavit sets, but the applicable count for your category must be read from Annexure-1 or Annexure-2. In the platform, store this as a *configurable checklist per category*, never as a hard-coded number.

Before the hackathon demo: download the current Approval Process Handbook from aicte.gov.in, and fill every "Verify" row. Cite real clause numbers only after checking them.

1. Regulatory Frame

Item	Detail	Status
Governing handbook	Approval Process Handbook (APH) 2024-25 to 2026-27, with corrigenda and amendments issued from time to time	Confirmed

Item	Detail	Status
Application mode	Online on the AICTE web portal. Documents are uploaded there and **need not be sent to AICTE HQ**	Confirmed
2026-27 public notice	Portal went live on 28 Nov 2025 for new institutions, extension of approval (EoA), and ODL/online programmes in Management and Computer Applications	Confirmed
New institutions	Must apply through the National Single Window System (NSWS)	Confirmed
Universities	Central, State or Private universities seeking AICTE approval for technical programmes must apply for **all** programmes. Partial approval is not permitted. (The handbook also notes university approval is not compulsory under the AICTE Act, but is needed to use AICTE schemes and initiatives.)	Confirmed
Deemed universities	AICTE approval mandatory from AY 2018-19 (Supreme Court order of 03-11-2017)	Confirmed
Deadline 2026-27	Reported last date without penalty 12 Jan 2026; late-fee window 13-20 Jan 2026	Reported
Digital signature	Application document sets are digitally signed (DSC). New-institution sets are signed by the Chairman	Confirmed (abbreviation DSC); Verify signer details
Document status of the record	If an EoA letter differs from the Council's record, the Executive/General Council record is final	Confirmed

2. Application Categories (drives the checklist)

The platform should detect the category first, then load the matching checklist.

#	Category	Document set	Status
1	New technical institution	Annexure-1 documents (via NSWS)	Confirmed
2	Extension of Approval (EoA) based on **self-disclosure**	Annexure-2 documents, as applicable	Confirmed
3	EoA with **additional/new programme or level** by an existing institution	Annexure-2 plus additional documents	Confirmed
4	EoA **after a break** in earlier years (the institution did not apply on its own)	Annexure-2	Confirmed
5	EoA with **zero intake** for the current year	Annexure-2 (as applicable)	Confirmed
6	Approval after **hibernation / restoration of intake**	Per APH Chapter II; Verify exact set	Verify
7	**Three-year EoA** for outstanding institutions	Granted by AICTE on eligibility; letters show "Extended EoA" for 3 years	Confirmed
8	**Off-campus** centre	Annexure-1 documents	Confirmed
9	**Change of site / location**	Prior Council approval, advocate certificate for the new site	Confirmed (approval requirement); Verify document list
10	**Progressive or complete closure**	Affidavit 4; no pending court case filed by AICTE and no charge sheet against the institution	Confirmed
11	ODL / online mode programmes (Management, Computer Applications)	Per APH ODL chapter	Verify

#	Category	Document set	Status
12	Change in name, trust/society, or similar	Per APH	Verify

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3. Document Checklist (Extension of Approval and Related Categories)

This is the working list assembled from the handbook excerpts and from institution checklists published on college sites. Mark each item `required`, `conditional` or `n/a` per category in your configuration.

3.1 Institution identity and governance

#	Document	Why checked	Status
1	Registration certificate of the Trust / Society / Company, with current name	Name must match the application and all other documents	Verify
2	Resolution / authorisation of the managing body for the application	Authority of signatory	Confirmed (resolution referred to in the self-declaration)
3	NOC from Directors / Promoters (where applicable)	Governance consent	Confirmed
4	Portal-generated **Affidavit(s)**, signed and digitally signed	Legal undertaking about facilities, faculty, truthfulness	Confirmed
5	Affidavit that other programmes or institutions (if any) run or do not run on the same land and building	Prevents shared-premises misuse	Confirmed
6	Previous approval / EoA letters	Check history and approved intake	Confirmed (system record)

3.2 Land documents

#	Document	Status
7	Land documents in the name of the Trust/Society/Company (or a lease agreement)	Confirmed
8	Documents showing possession of the land in the Trust/Society/Company name	Reported
9	Classification-of-land certificate from the competent authority	Reported
10	Land Conversion Certificate (issued by the competent authority of the State)	Confirmed
11	Land Use Certificate	Reported
12	Private lease: title documents of the lessor (if applicable)	Reported
13	Private lease: NOC of the Charity Commissioner / Registrar (if applicable)	Reported
14	Encumbrance Certificate for the property (if applicable)	Reported
15	Certificate issued by an **Advocate** regarding land-related documents	Confirmed

3.3 Building documents

#	Document	Status
16	Approved building plan and certificate by an Architect on approved site and building plan	Reported
17	**Occupancy / Completion / Building License / Form D** (as applicable) from the competent authority, valid (APH clause 7.17)	Confirmed
18	Structural stability certificate	Reported
19	Details of building completion (partial or full), including room-wise carpet area and electrification	Confirmed

3.4 Fire and safety

#	Document	Status
20	**Fire Safety Certificate** from the competent authority, valid. If renewal is applied for, proof of application is attached	Confirmed
21	For new institutions: Fire and Life Safety Certificate from the State Fire Department before applying	Confirmed

3.5 Affiliation and government permissions

#	Document	Status
22	**NOC from the Affiliating University and State/UT Government** (the institution's own responsibility to obtain)	Confirmed
23	Receipt/proof from the affiliating university or board (as shown in college checklists)	Reported
24	NOC/permission from the State Government for programmes or intake, where applicable	Verify
25	Accreditation details (NBA/NAAC) or autonomy status, where claimed	Confirmed (referenced in EoA letters for faculty-student ratio)

3.6 Academic, faculty and infrastructure data (entered on the portal)

#	Item	Status
26	Programme-wise approved and proposed **intake**	Confirmed
27	**Faculty details**: department-wise name, designation, qualification, cadre	Confirmed
28	Principal/Director and Heads of Department details	Confirmed
29	Department-wise **infrastructure**: laboratories, workshops, computer centre, library, classrooms	Confirmed

#	Item	Status
30	Built-up area and room-wise carpet area	Confirmed
31	Mandatory Disclosure on the institution's website (APH Annexure-18)	Confirmed

3.7 Payment and compliance

#	Item	Status
32	**TER (Technical Education Regulation) charges** per the APH tables (EoA: Table 2.1, Chapter II; new institutions: Table 1.1, Chapter I)	Confirmed (table references); Verify amounts
33	Compliance or deficiency status from the previous year	Confirmed (AICTE record)
34	Anti-ragging compliance (AICTE Regulation of 1 July 2009)	Confirmed

Counting note for your demo: items 1-34 above are the *consolidated checklist* used for the prototype (about 34 line items). Present it as "configurable checklist, count varies by category and state".

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4. Norms the Rules Engine Should Check

Norm	Rule	Status
Faculty-student ratio, Engineering/Technology UG and PG	**1:20**	Confirmed
Faculty-student ratio, MBA/PGDM and MCA	**1:20**	Confirmed
Faculty-student ratio, Diploma	**1:25**	Reported (Appendix 7 excerpt)
Faculty-student ratio, integrated planning	1:16 for first three years, then 1:10	Reported

Norm	Rule	Status
Cadre ratio (Professor : Associate Professor : Assistant Professor), UG	**1 : 2 : 6** or better (not applicable at Diploma level)	Confirmed
Faculty calculation	Include basic-science and first-year faculty in the calculation	Reported
Adjunct/resource faculty	Up to 10% of faculty (stated for 2023-24; Verify current rule)	Reported
Land	Land area requirement was rationalised: the **built-up area** is what counts, with the same land norm for rural, urban and metro. The older table (2.5 acres urban, 7.5 acres rural for UG engineering) is obsolete	Reported
New engineering institution	At least **three core branches plus one emerging-area course**	Confirmed
Affiliated institutions	Where accreditation/autonomy status exists, faculty-student ratio as specified in the handbook must be maintained	Confirmed
Combined shifts	Institutions running shifts earlier now treat them as a **total intake** and must meet infrastructure, faculty and other norms for the total approved intake	Confirmed
Area norms (classrooms, labs, workshops, library, administrative, amenities)	Carpet-area table by programme and intake, per handbook	Verify (read the current table)
Faculty qualifications	As per AICTE norms for each cadre	Verify

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5. Essential Requirements and EoA Conditions

Every EoA letter makes approval subject to these. Treat them as mandatory compliance checks (APH 2024-27 Chapter-VI):

1. Strict compliance with the **Anti-Ragging Regulation** (AICTE, 1 July 2009).
2. Committee for **SC/ST** students.
3. Internal Complaints Committee (**ICC**) for sexual harassment prevention.
4. **Online grievance redressal** mechanism.
5. **Barrier-free built environment** for disabled and elderly persons.
6. **Fire and Safety Certificate** kept valid.
7. **Mandatory Disclosure** on the website (department-wise infrastructure, approved courses and intake, faculty names, designations and qualifications).
8. Facilities, faculty and other norms met for the **total approved intake**.

Also confirmed: the institution must follow the Council's procedure for any change of site (approval first), and EoA is subject to the Council's record.

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6. Fees and Validity

Item	Detail	Status
TER charges	Defined in APH Table 2.1 (Chapter II) for EoA and Table 1.1 (Chapter I) for new institutions. Read the amounts from the handbook	Confirmed (references); Verify amounts
Three-year EoA	Where granted, EoA letters state approval for three years (for example 2026-27 to 2028-29), and TER charges for EoA are waived in that period. The letter must be downloaded from the portal each year	Confirmed
Validity	One academic year for normal EoA, three years for the extended EoA	Confirmed
Late fee	A late-fee window applied after the regular last date in 2026-27	Reported

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7. Process Flow (for the workflow diagram)

1. Institution registers and logs in on the AICTE portal (new institutions via NSWS).
2. Selects the **category** (Section 2).
3. Fills institution, programme, intake, faculty and infrastructure data.

4. Uploads documents and affidavits (digitally signed).
5. Pays TER charges where applicable.
6. Submits online.
7. Scrutiny by AICTE (document scrutiny, with self-scrutiny, expert-committee or physical verification modes depending on the case: Verify mode names).
8. Deficiencies are communicated; the institution rectifies within the allowed process.
9. Approval decision by the competent authority; EoA letter generated on the portal.

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8. Mapping Requirements to Your Platform

Requirement	Check type	Detection method	Verification source (real or simulated)
Fire Safety Certificate valid	Expiry date vs. application date	OCR date extraction plus rule	State fire department (simulated adapter), QR
Occupancy / Completion / Form D valid	Presence plus date plus issuing authority	OCR plus rule	Local body / planning authority (simulated)
Land document in trust name	Name match	Fuzzy match against registration record	Registrar / land record (simulated)
Land Conversion Certificate	Presence plus issuing authority	Classifier plus rule	State revenue portal (simulated)
Advocate certificate	Presence, signature, format	Classifier plus signature check	Manual
NOC affiliating university and State	Presence, validity, intake match	OCR, intake vs. application	University portal (simulated), QR
Affidavits	Portal-generated, signed, dated, e-stamp	Digital-signature validation (`pyHanko`), date logic	Digital signature
Intake applied vs. approved	Numeric comparison	Rule against AICTE records	AICTE record service (mock)

Requirement	Check type	Detection method	Verification source (real or simulated)
Faculty-student ratio	Compute from faculty list and intake	Rule (1:20, cadre 1:2:6)	AICTE faculty records
Faculty duplication across colleges	Cross-institution identity check	Join on faculty UID across institutions	AICTE faculty registry (mock)
Built-up and carpet area	Area vs. requirement	Floor-plan area extraction plus rule	Advisory, inspection if unclear
Mandatory Disclosure	Website contains required sections	Crawl check or declared URL review	Public website
TER payment	Paid or not	Record lookup	Payment record (mock)
Anti-ragging, ICC, grievance, SC/ST committee	Declaration present	Affidavit text extraction	Self-declaration, inspection if flagged
Break in EoA history	Previous years' status	Record lookup	AICTE application history

Rule design reminder: each rule has `id`, `description`, `severity`, `handbook_ref` (clause), `applies_to_categories`, `effective_from`, and `version`. Keep clause numbers as placeholders until verified.

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9. Gaps to Fill From the Handbook (Action List)

Open item	Where to read
Exact document list per category (count)	Annexure-1 (new institutions) and Annexure-2 (EoA and related)
TER amounts	Tables 1.1 and 2.1
Carpet-area tables per programme	Appendix on norms (area requirements)
Faculty qualification rules, PG cadre ratios	Appendix 7
Essential requirements wording	Chapter-VI
Mandatory disclosure format	Annexure-18 (page 180 of the APH)

Open item	Where to read
Affidavit formats (Affidavit 2, Affidavit 4, others)	Annexures/appendices of affidavits
Hibernation, ODL, name-change process	Relevant chapters
Latest amendments and corrigenda	aicte.gov.in notices (they override the base handbook)

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10. Fees, Deposits and Refunds (More Detail)

Item	Detail	Status
Application fee	A fee of Rs 6,000 through the payment gateway gives a unique user ID and password for each new application	Confirmed
TER charges	Paid online through the AICTE payment gateway. The rate depends on institution type (government or self-financing), programme and intake; see Table 2.1 for the exact amounts	Confirmed; Verify amounts
Annual increase	TER charges rise by 10% every year	Confirmed
Intake-based steps	For multiple divisions the FAQ describes step-ups per batch of 60 seats (Rs 20,000 for self-financing or private, Rs 5,000 for government institutions, pro rata)	Reported; Verify
Postgraduate exemption	No TER charges for postgraduate degree courses other than MCA and the other exceptions the handbook names	Confirmed; Verify exact exceptions
Existing UG management and computer applications (BBA, BMS, BCA)	Table 1.1 charges do not apply to existing institutions; only the Table 2.1 charges apply	Confirmed

Item	Detail	Status
Extra expert visit	In some cases an additional TER charge applies, for example Rs 0.60 lakh when an extra Expert Visit Committee (online or physical) is needed	Confirmed; Verify context
Refund	TER charges are not refunded if an application is processed and rejected. Refunds on withdrawal are paid after a stated deduction (the handbook mentions deductions such as Rs 0.25 lakh or Rs 0.60 lakh in different cases)	Confirmed; Verify
Security deposit	Newer institutions (under five years old) keep a refundable security deposit with AICTE (Table 1.4, Chapter I)	Confirmed
Late submission	A late fee or penalty applies after the last date (for example Rs 5,000 for the 2024-25 BBA/BCA/BMS reopening)	Reported
Closure revoked	If a closure is revoked, TER charges for EoA plus the late-submission penalty must be paid	Confirmed
Change in bank details	Carries its own TER charge	Confirmed; Verify amount
Student fees	Tuition and other fees must follow the competent authority and the Council's criteria. **No capitation fee in any form**	Confirmed

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11. Three-Year Extension of Approval

Existing institutions may get EoA for three years at once, paying three years' TER charges up front (Table 2.1), if they meet **any one** of the criteria in the handbook.

Criterion	Detail	Status
NIRF	Ranked in the NIRF edition named by the handbook (the 8th edition, announced 5 June 2023, for AY 2024-25)	Confirmed
QS and similar rankings	Listed as another route	Reported
Accreditation and enrolment	At least 30% of courses NBA-accredited and about 80% enrolment over the last three years	Reported; Verify
Yearly duties during the period	Download the EoA letter from the portal each year, and submit updated institutional information	Confirmed
Penalty	In case of violation, the Council can take penal action and **withdraw the extended EoA**	Confirmed
Hibernation	Institutions in an approved hibernation period are exempt from applying; a four-year UG institution can take a limited break (the press reported up to three years)	Reported; Verify

Platform use: the rules engine needs a `three_year_eligibility` rule set, and a yearly reminder rule for the annual updates.

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12. Master List: Everything an Institution Must Have Ready

Use this as the complete "readiness" checklist in the college portal. Each item maps to a document, a data field, or a declaration. "Core" means expected for most EoA applications; "If applicable" depends on the case.

#	Requirement	Type	When
1	Trust/Society/Company registration certificate	Document	Core
2	Bye-laws / memorandum showing objectives and managing body	Document	Core (Verify)
3	Managing body resolution authorising the application	Document	Core

#	Requirement	Type	When
4	NOC from Directors/Promoters	Document	If applicable
5	Portal-generated affidavits, digitally signed	Affidavit	Core
6	Affidavit on other programmes sharing the land and building	Affidavit	Core
7	Land ownership or lease documents in the trust name	Document	Core
8	Possession proof	Document	Core (Reported)
9	Land classification / use certificate	Document	Core (Reported)
10	Land Conversion Certificate	Document	Core
11	Lease: lessor title documents, Charity Commissioner/Registrar NOC	Document	If leased
12	Encumbrance Certificate	Document	If applicable
13	Advocate certificate on land documents	Certificate	Core
14	Approved building plan and architect certificate	Document	Core (Reported)
15	Occupancy / Completion / Building License / Form D, valid	Certificate	Core (clause 7.17)
16	Structural stability certificate	Certificate	Core (Reported)
17	Fire Safety Certificate, valid, or proof of renewal application	Certificate	Core
18	Building completion details (room-wise carpet area, electrification)	Data	Core
19	NOC from the Affiliating University and State/UT Government	Document	Core, where affiliated
20	University/board receipt or affiliation proof	Document	Core (Reported)
21	Accreditation proofs (NBA/NAAC) and NIRF status, if claimed	Document	If claimed
22	Audited financial statements for the last three financial years	Document	Core (disclosure requirement)

#	Requirement	Type	When
23	Programme-wise approved intake and applied intake	Data	Core
24	Faculty list: name, designation, qualification, cadre, department	Data	Core
25	Principal/Director and HoD details	Data	Core
26	Faculty-student ratio met for the total approved intake (1:20 for UG engineering)	Computed	Core
27	Cadre ratio 1:2:6 or better for UG	Computed	Core
28	Laboratories, workshops, computer centre, library, classrooms by department	Data	Core
29	Built-up area and room-wise carpet area per norms	Data	Core
30	Anti-ragging compliance	Declaration	Core
31	SC/ST committee	Declaration	Core
32	Internal Complaints Committee	Declaration	Core
33	Online grievance redressal	Declaration	Core
34	Barrier-free environment	Declaration	Core
35	Mandatory Disclosure published on the institution website (Annexure-18)	Website	Core
36	No capitation fee; fees as per competent authority	Declaration	Core
37	TER payment	Payment	Core
38	Previous EoA letters and compliance/deficiency history	System record	Core
39	Off-campus centre documents (Annexure-1 set)	Documents	If applicable
40	Change-of-site approval and advocate certificate for the new site	Documents	If applicable
41	Closure: Affidavit 4, no pending AICTE court case or charge sheet	Affidavit	If applicable

#	Requirement	Type	When
42	New programme or level: additional Annexure-2 documents	Documents	If applicable
43	Break-in-EoA or restoration documents	Documents	If applicable
44	ODL/online programme documents	Documents	If applicable (Verify)
45	Name or trust change documents	Documents	If applicable (Verify)

These 45 items are the prototype's complete master list. The AICTE portal may show fewer or more entries for a given category and state, so keep the list editable.

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13. Scrutiny Basis (Useful for Your Rules)

- Applications are processed by the Scrutiny / Re-Scrutiny Committee or Expert Visit Committee (where applicable), **strictly on the documents uploaded on the portal**. This supports your pre-scrutiny design: whatever is not uploaded cannot be considered.
- Computer-generated EoA letters list approved programmes and intake. Any difference is resolved by the Council's record.
- The EoA letter tells institutions to keep complying with the essential requirements in Chapter-VI and to publish the mandatory disclosure.

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14. Sources Used

- AICTE Approval Process Handbook 2024-25 to 2026-27 (excerpts): cdnbbsr.s3waas.gov.in (AICTE-hosted PDF), and handbook copies on college sites
- AICTE Public Notice for Approval Process 2026-27 (28 Nov 2025)
- AICTE FAQ, Approval Process 2024-25 (aicte.gov.in)
- AICTE-generated EoA letters 2021-22 to 2026-27 published by institutions (conditions, essential requirements, three-year EoA wording)
- AICTE Appendix 7 excerpt (faculty norms) and revised-format excerpts
- Institution "Info to AICTE" pages showing portal checklist items
- Secondary reporting on land and faculty-student ratio changes (2023) and the 2026-27 deadline extension

Disclaimer: this is a working reference for a prototype, not legal or regulatory advice. The authoritative text is the current Approval Process Handbook and AICTE notices.